Samantha Ashley Carbonell
Lead Product Designer
www.smashley.net

Design leader with 10+ years of product and systems experience, focused on growing designers, aligning cross-functional teams, and delivering end-to-end experiences with measurable impact. Known for building clarity — in design systems, in process, and in people.

Education

Virginia Commonwealth University
Bachelor of Fine Arts, Graphic Design
2012 · Richmond, VA

General Assembly
User Experience Design Course
2015 · Washington, DC

Work Experience

Publix · Lead Product Designer *Remote · 2021 - present*

- Delivered measurable end-to-end product impact across iOS and Android: 2× increase in sign-up rate, 2 minute reduction in checkout completion time, and 22% increase in pay-online rates
- Mentored and led a rotating team of designers through 1:1s, critiques, and feedback; contributed to hiring and onboarding 7 designers, including authoring process documentation to accelerate ramp-up
- Influenced product roadmap regularly through research-driven insights and presentations to leadership, shaping prioritization and strategic direction
- Built and scaled the Publix Design Language (PDL) — 56 core components, developer handoff standards, and foundational UI/UX patterns adopted across 67% of the app
- Defined org-wide design ops standards including Figma file structure and research prototyping workflows

CarMax · Sr Systems Designer *Remote · Jan–Jun 2021*

- Founded and led a cross-functional Design System Guild, aligning 30+ designers across teams to standardize practices, surface friction, and drive system-wide adoption
- Authored component usage guidelines, improving clarity and consistency in implementation

Shockoe · Sr UX/UI Mobile App Designer *Remote · 2016 - 2021*

- Drove early-stage product exploration, rapidly prototyping and iterating on concepts to validate ideas, inform product direction, and reduce risk
- Led end-to-end design for iOS, Android, and cross-platform enterprise apps across new product builds, rebrands, and audits
- Established team processes and quality standards across research, critiques, and developer handoff, improving consistency and delivery

circle S studio · Web & Graphic Designer *Richmond, VA · 2010 - 2016*

- Designed responsive websites, branding systems, and large-scale marketing materials across digital and physical mediums
- Built a strong foundation in visual design, balancing aesthetics with usability and clear communication

Skills

Core

Product Design · UX/UI Design · Interaction Design · Design Systems · Design Leadership · People Management · Product Strategy · Information Architecture

Advanced

Design Mentorship · Design Critique & Feedback · Cross-functional Collaboration · Stakeholder Management · Roadmap Influence · Design Operations · Rapid Prototyping · Usability Testing · Concept Exploration

Tools

Figma · Adobe Creative Suite · Lottie · AI-assisted tools (Claude, GitHub Copilot, Cursor) · UserTesting · Maze · Jira